

Informed Consent Form

This is the informed-consent screen presented to participants within the experiment platform before any study data are collected (referenced as Supplementary Information S7). Bracketed items are finalized before IRB submission and platform launch.

Consent for Participation in Research

Protocol Title: When Agentic AI Entrenches Human Review: Detecting Systematic AI Errors

Principal Investigator: Jue Wang, The Pennsylvania State University, jjw6286@psu.edu, [phone number]

Key Information

You are being asked to volunteer for a research study about how people work with AI tools to complete a business task. Below is some key information to help you decide whether to participate; additional detail follows in later sections.

- Your participation is entirely voluntary, and you may stop at any time.
- The study takes about 35 minutes and involves completing a business analysis task, either on your own, with an AI chat assistant, or by reviewing a completed AI work product, followed by a few short questionnaires.
- The risks are minimal — comparable to ordinary computer-based work or survey-taking.
- You will receive a base payment plus a performance bonus, described under “Will I be paid to take part in this research?” below.
- As explained below, we do not disclose every detail of the study’s purpose until after you finish, because knowing everything in advance could change how you complete the task. You will receive a full explanation immediately afterward.

Introduction

The purpose of this form is to give you the information you need to decide whether to take part in this research study. The researcher will answer any questions you have. Take your time, read the information below, and ask any questions before deciding whether to participate. If you decide to take part, this form is used to record your consent. You must be at least 18 years of age to participate.

What is the purpose of the study?

You are being asked to participate in a research study about how people complete business tasks with the help of AI tools.

The purpose of this study is to understand how different ways of working with AI — for example, using an AI assistant while you complete a task yourself, versus reviewing a task an AI has already completed — affect how carefully people check the final work.

Some research requires that the full purpose of the study not be explained before you participate, because knowing everything in advance could change how you complete the task and would compromise the scientific validity of the study. We will give you a full explanation, including the nature of any errors embedded in the study materials, as soon as you finish the study.

Do I have to participate?

No, your participation is voluntary. You may decide not to participate at all, or, if you start the study, you may withdraw at any time. Withdrawal or refusal to participate will not affect your relationship with The Pennsylvania State University, Prolific, CloudResearch, or any other platform through which you were recruited, in any way.

If you would like to participate, click “I agree and wish to participate” at the end of this form. You may save or print a copy of this form for your records before continuing.

Why am I being asked to take part in this research study?

You are being asked to take part in this study because you are an adult residing in the United States or Canada who can plausibly perform the kind of business task used in this study (for example, you have experience as an analyst, consultant, product manager, founder, finance or accounting professional, operations manager, or MBA student). Your participation is completely voluntary, and you may refuse to participate or stop at any time without penalty.

How many people will take part in this study and how long will it take?

This study will include approximately 920 participants recruited through Prolific and CloudResearch. Your participation will last about 35 minutes in a single online session.

What will I be asked to do?

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

- Answer a few brief questions about your work experience and background.
- Read instructions describing a short business case and complete a brief comprehension check.
- Complete a short warm-up business task on your own.
- Complete the main business task under one of the following conditions, assigned at random: (1) working on your own; (2) using an AI chat assistant that you direct as you complete the task; or (3) reviewing and approving a business work product that an AI has already completed.

- Write brief responses explaining your reasoning and what you checked.
- Answer a few closing questions about your experience completing the task.

The task and the AI tools involved are experimental research materials; they are not commercial products, and any recommendations they produce are for research purposes only and should not be relied on for real business decisions.

What are the risks or discomforts involved in this study?

The risks involved in this study are low. You may experience mild frustration, boredom, or fatigue similar to that of ordinary computer-based work or survey-taking. There is also a small risk to the confidentiality of your data, which we minimize as described under “How will my information be protected?” below.

The researchers will tell you about any important new information learned during the study that might affect your willingness to continue participating.

What are the possible benefits of this study?

You will not directly benefit from participating in this study. However, the study may produce societal benefits by helping researchers and organizations understand when human review of AI-completed work is, and is not, a reliable safeguard against AI errors.

Will participating in the study cost me anything?

No. Taking part in this research study will not cost you anything.

Will there be any travel or other study-associated costs?

No. You will not be reimbursed for any costs because none are expected; the study is completed entirely online.

Will I be paid to take part in this research?

Yes. You will receive a base payment of [\$X] for your participation, for an expected 35-minute session, plus a performance bonus of up to [\$Y] based on the accuracy of your final answers and, where applicable, on identifying planted errors in the task materials. Payment will be issued through the Prolific or CloudResearch platform through which you were recruited, in accordance with your agreement with that platform and its standard payment terms and schedule.

How will my information be protected?

We will make every effort to protect the confidentiality of your study records, but we cannot guarantee total confidentiality. Your responses will be linked to a research ID rather than your name, stored on password-protected, encrypted university systems accessible only to the research team, and retained in accordance with Penn State’s research data

policies. Your information may also be viewed by people responsible for overseeing research at Penn State, including the Institutional Review Board (IRB), and, because you are recruited through Prolific or CloudResearch, those platforms will have access to information needed to administer your participation and payment (such as your platform ID), governed by their own privacy policies. If this study's results are published or presented, your name and other identifying information will not be used.

If you are located in Canada, your data will be transferred to and stored in the United States, which may have different data-protection laws than Canada. The protections described above apply regardless of where you are located.

What will happen if I decide to withdraw from the study?

If you decide to leave the study before finishing, simply close the browser window or exit the platform; you are not required to give a reason. Partial responses may not be eligible for the full payment or bonus, consistent with the recruiting platform's standard policies for incomplete submissions. After you leave the study, no new information will be collected from you; information already collected up to that point may be retained and used in the study's analysis unless you separately contact the research team to request its removal before data analysis has begun.

Who can I contact with questions about the study?

Before, during, or after your participation, you can contact the Principal Investigator, Jue Wang (jjw6286@psu.edu), with any questions or concerns about the study.

Who can I contact with questions concerning my rights as a research participant?

Before, during, or after your participation, you can contact the Penn State Office for Research Protections at [phone number] or [email address] to discuss problems, concerns, or questions about the research or about your rights as a participant, to obtain information, or to offer input. This office is not affiliated with the research study, and you may contact it anonymously if you wish.

Consenting to be in this study

You have been informed about this study's purpose, procedures, possible benefits, and risks, and you may save or print a copy of this form. You have had the opportunity to ask questions before continuing, and you may ask further questions at any time by contacting the Principal Investigator. Your participation is entirely voluntary.

If you click "I agree and wish to participate" below, it means you have read this consent form and agree to take part in this study. By agreeing to participate, you are not waiving any of your legal rights.

- ☐ I have read and understood the information above and voluntarily agree to participate in this study.
- ☐ I do not wish to participate in this study.

Version 1.0 — draft of July 6, 2026; to be finalized before IRB submission and platform launch.